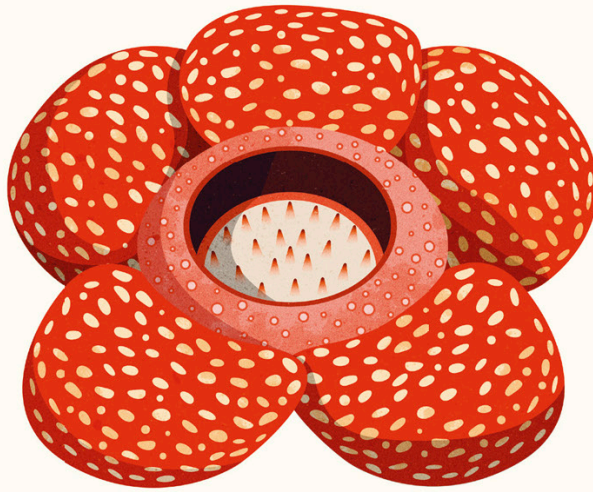


*Each giant corpse flower takes
up to nine months to grow, but it only
blooms for a few days.*

Corpse flower



Luckily, this plant does not come into flower very often. Usually, we enjoy the smell of flowers... but not this time! When the five leathery petals of the corpse flower open up, the terrible stink is like a corpse, or dead body. The awful whiff attracts swarms of tiny flies, which then carry its sticky pollen to other corpse flowers. The pollen is just like human snot. Yuck!

The corpse flower lives in rainforests and is the biggest single flower on the planet. It can be 1 m (3 ft) wide and weigh as much as a turkey. Instead of having its own roots, the plant is a parasite that grows inside other rainforest plants and steals their food.

Corpse flower,
Southeast Asia